

Coasters For Sale!

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.8 GHz, Intel Original GEBV2, 256 MB RAM, LG 52x CD-Writer, and a 40 GB HDD. When I try to burn a disc, it writes to the 56% mark before giving me an error saying "Couldn't perform end track". I have lost about 30 to 40 CDs!

Manjunath Prakash

A Since you haven't mentioned which software you use for writing, I'd suggest trying to use a different software—Nero is good. If the problem persists, try the following. Assuming you're using Nero:

- 1 Decrease the write speed a few notches (the drive might have a problem only with high speeds)
 - 2 Enable buffer underrun protection if it's turned off
 - 3 Use a CD lens cleaner
 - 4 Download the latest firmware for the optical drive and flash it. Most manufacturers periodically post new revisions of firmware aimed at fixing bugs
 - 5 Try using a different brand of media
- If all this fails, get the drive replaced if it is under warranty. And if that's not the case, it's shopping time!

Express, but after burning it, I can't see anything on the DVD (although I'd gotten a successful "burnt" message).

Anindya Sunder Sen

A The fact that the extracted file is coming in with the .dlm extension is abnormal. Also, UltraISO showing only one file (the Readme) suggests that the download is corrupted. Redownload the file. We'd suggest using a good download manager such as FlashGet, which you can find on this month's CD.

So Who Am I?

Q I run Windows XP SP2. I've installed Nokia PC Suite for my Nokia 3250. When I browsed my memory card reader, I didn't get the folder options menu at all. When I go into Help and Support and go into Folder Options, I get an error saying, "This operation has been cancelled due to restrictions in effect on this computer. Please contact your system administrator." But I *am* the system administrator!

Vignesh

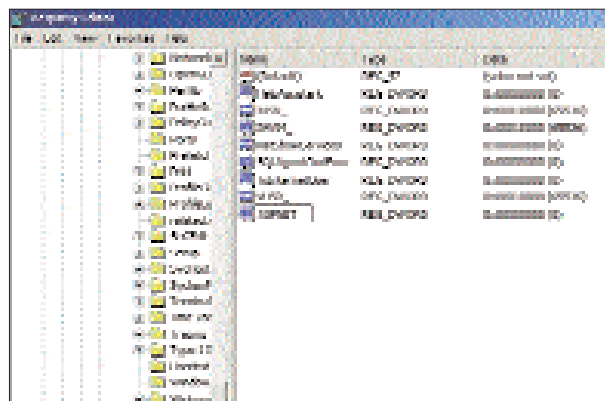
A It looks like your Folder Options menu has disappeared either because of utilities that make changes to the registry, or because some other user has set this restriction. To fix this, in the Registry Editor, navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies, there, look for a value called NoFolderOptions, double-click it and change the value from 1 to 0. Do the same in HKEY_CURRENT_USER. You should now be able to see Folder Options under the Tools menu in Windows Explorer.

Who's That?

Q There's always a user called "ASP.NET" on my XP Welcome screen. I tried deleting the user, but doing so also deletes some of the files in My Documents. I cannot even log in to that user account, as it is password-protected. How do I get rid of it?

Amit Jha

A First, there's no need to worry about this "user": neither is it a virus, nor will it interfere with your work. It's created when you install the Microsoft .NET framework. If



Make a DWORD value for the user to be added in special accounts

you want to prevent it from showing up altogether in the welcome screen, you can add ASP.NET to the special accounts list. To do this, in the Registry Editor, go to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\SpecialAccounts\Userlist. Right-click in the right pane and select New > DWORD Value, enter "ASP.NET", and press [Enter].

Toneless?

Q I have a D-Link modem that reports that it does not detect a dial tone when I try to connect to the Internet. What could be the problem?

Abul Khair

A You first need to check whether the dial tone is available at the telephone outlet. If you have a dedicated line for your modem, then you must connect it to a telephone and make sure that a dial tone exists.

Next, you need to disable "Wait for dial tone." To do this, open the Control Panel, double-click "Phone and Modem Options", select the Modems tab, select the modem, and click Properties. Under the General tab, deselect "Wait for dial tone before dialing".

If that doesn't work, remove the phone jack from your modem and reconnect it. If that doesn't work, check both ends of the phone cable to make sure the connection is good. Use a different cable to connect your modem to the telephone outlet.

Go through the modem manual to see if your modem requires an initialisation string. If it does, try setting those. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!